

Summary Provenance & Attribution Research

Introduction

In November 2019 I acquired a landscape painting at an art auction in The Hague, Netherlands (see photo below). At present the painting is attributed to the Dutch 17th century landscapist Frans de Hulst (1605/07-1661), considered to be a contemporary follower of the leading Dutch landscapists of the first decades of the 17th century, Salomon van Ruysdael and Jan van Goyen, whilst previously the painting has been attributed to the aforementioned landscapist Salomon van Ruysdael (1600/02-1670).

Since the start of 2020 I have been conducting a private research project related to both the provenance and attribution of the painting with the intention to write a book on my research and research findings which I expect to complete in draft form for publication in 2026 or 2027.

Erik H. van der Graaf – January 2026



riverscape, oil on oval panel, dimensions 39 x 53 cm
previously attributed to Salomon van Ruysdael, currently attributed to Frans de Hulst

I - Provenance

So far I have been able to establish some parts of the provenance of the painting as a result of research via information sources in both The Netherlands, France, Germany, Poland, Czech Republic, Hungary, UK, Austria, Switzerland, Sweden, Denmark and the US apart from extensive literature and archive research.

The established sequence of provenance so far covers the period between circa 1860-1870 and 2019 and includes the French-Polish portrait painter Count André Mniszech, his son Count Léon Mniszech, Hungarian art dealer François Kleinberger, Hungarian art collector Gustav von Gerhardt, Czech art collector Otto Kuhn, his wife Olga 'Olly' Kuhn, Dutch art dealer and auctioneer Paul Brandt, Dutch art dealers Nathan and Benjamin Katz, Dutch art collector Frank Mignot, his wife and his daughter Marianne Mignot who did put up the painting for sale via auction in 2019. The painting has previously been sold via public auction in 1902 (Paris), in 1911 (Berlin) and in 1929 (Amsterdam) before being presented at the 2019 auction in The Hague.

provisional overview provenance

previous owner	duration of ownership	acquisition
Count André Mniszech	probably between 1860-1870 until 1885	probably via art dealer or public auction
Count Léon Mniszech	1885 until 1901	donation by his father Count André Mniszech
François Kleinberger	1902 until ?	acquisition via auction in Paris in 1902
Gustav von Gerhardt	? until 1910	acquisition via art dealer François Kleinberger
Otto Kuhn	1911 until 1927	acquisition via auction in Berlin in 1911
Olga 'Olly' Kuhn	1927 until 1929	inheritance via her husband Otto Kuhn
Paul Brandt	1929 until ?	acquisition via auction in Amsterdam in 1929
gap in provenance		
Benjamin & Nathan Katz	probably about 1935 until 1938	probably acquisition via private collector
Frank Mignot	probably about 1938 until 2003	acquisition via art dealers Benjamin & Nathan Katz
Marilies Mignot- Biermann	2003 until 2016	inheritance via her husband Frank Mignot
Marianne Mignot	2016 until 2019	inheritance via her mother Marilies Mignot-Biermann
Erik van der Graaf	2019 - present	acquisition via auction in The Hague in 2019

Photo gallery identified previous owners (part 1)

This section includes photos of some of the previous owners of the painting I have been able to identify so far as a result of my provenance research.



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1. Count Andrzej (André) Jerzy Mniszech (1823-1905) (self-portrait, circa 1880)

Polish-French portrait painter and art collector; he probably acquired the painting via an art dealer or public auction in France between 1860 and 1870. Count Mniszech emigrated from Poland to France in 1853 and established himself in Paris as a leading portrait painter of members of the French high society and Polish émigrés.

2. Count Léon Mniszech (1849-1901)

Austrian-French military officer and only son of Count André Mniszech; he acquired the painting from his father in 1885 as part of a donation consisting of the then art and painting collection established by Mniszech senior and at the occasion of the death of his mother Countess Anna Elzbieta Potocka (1827-1885) and first wife of Count André Mniszech.

3. François (Franz; Ferenc) Kleinberger (1862-1929)

Hungarian international art dealer, specialist in old master paintings, operating through dealerships in Paris and later also in New York. Kleinberger predominantly focused on Dutch and Flemish old masters and sold paintings to leading collectors and museums in Europe and the US. He acquired the painting at the occasion of the public auction of the Léon Mniszech estate on April 9, 1902 in Paris.

Photo gallery identified previous owners (part 2)



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4. Gustav von Gerhardt (1847-1910)

Hungarian art collector and president of the Hungarian railways, Von Gerhardt established a renowned art collection including Meissen porcelain, snuff boxes, furniture, old master paintings and other works of art. He acquired the painting most likely via his close friend and art dealer François Kleinberger soon after the 1902 auction in Paris.

5. Otto Kuhn (1865-1927)

Czech art collector and cloth manufacturer Otto Kuhn built a considerable collection of predominantly Dutch old master paintings. Kuhn acquired the painting at the occasion of the public auction of the Von Gerhardt collection on November 10, 1911 in Berlin.



6

6. Paul Brandt (left) (1900-1984)

After the death of Czech art collector Otto Kuhn his wife Olga 'Olly' Kuhn put his entire painting collection up for sale in Amsterdam. Dutch auctioneer and art dealer Paul Brandt acquired the painting at the occasion of this public auction which was held on June 4, 1929.

Photo gallery identified previous owners (part 3)



7

7. Nathan Katz (1893-1949) & Benjamin Katz (1891-1962)

By 1930 the Dutch art dealers Nathan and Benjamin Katz took control of the modest art business established by their father and turned it into a leading dealership in – primarily – old master paintings. At first their business was focused on a Dutch clientele, but soon the Katz brothers were to deal throughout Europe and in the US. As Jews the Katz brothers faced increasing difficulties and threats during the German occupation, but managed to flee Holland with their direct relatives in return for which they handed over a Rembrandt painting to the Nazi regime.

Most likely the Katz brothers acquired my painting between 1935 and 1938 via a (yet unknown) private collector or held it on consignment before selling the painting on in or around 1938.

Additional provenance research

In addition to the previous and provisional overview of provenance, I have conducted extensive research into the provenance prior to the 1860-1870 period (during which the detected earliest owner - Count André Mnischech – probably acquired the painting) based on four most likely acquisition scenarios available to him:

Option 1: inheritance or (family) donation

Option 2: purchase via an art collector

Option 3: purchase via an art dealer

Option 4: purchase via a public auction

Option 1: inheritance

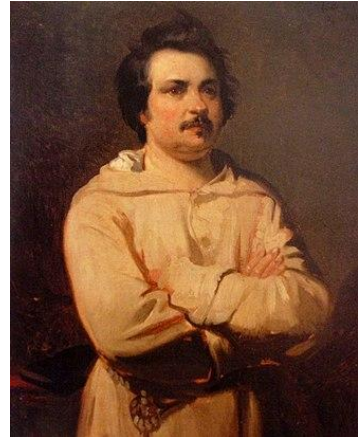
So far my investigations regarding the option of inheritance (to include the painting collection of the last King of Poland, Stanislaus August II Poniatowski, related to Count André Mniszech via his grandmother, the painting collection of his brother Count Georges Mniszech, the painting collection of his first wife Countess Anna Elzbieta Potocka and the painting collections of the mother-in-law of his brother, Countess Eveline Hańska and her second husband, French novel writer Honoré de Balzac) have been inconclusive, yet this acquisition option seems to be unlikely in view of the lack of detected evidence.



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1. Stanislaus August II Poniatowski (1732-1798), last king of Poland
2. Countess Eveline Hańska (1801-1882), wife of novel writer Honoré de Balzac
3. Honoré de Balzac (1799-1850), French novelist

Option 2: purchase via an art collector

Equally my investigations regarding the option of acquisition via an art collector (to include the painting collection of the French painter and tutor of Count André Mniszech, Jean François Gigoux, the painting collections of his close Dutch friends and art collectors Daniël Franken as well as Abraham Willet and his wife Louisa Willet-Holthuysen) have not produced any evidence to suggest that the painting originated from one of these particular sources.



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1. Jean François Gigoux (1806-1894), French history and portrait painter
2. Daniël Franken (1838-1898), Dutch banker and art collector
3. Abraham Willet (1825-1888), Dutch art collector

Option 3: purchase via an art dealer

Research into the option of acquisition via an art dealer included the primarily Paris based old master dealers. Among them were leading dealers with a focus on old master paintings of Dutch and Flemish origin such as Sedelmeyer, Petit and Kleinberger besides others.

So far the research of their archives, exhibition catalogues and auction catalogues hasn't produced any evidence to conclude that Count Mniszech purchased the painting from any of them, yet this trajectory is still part of ongoing research.



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1. Charles Sedelmeyer (1837-1925), Austrian-French art dealer
2. Georges Petit (1856-1920), French art dealer
3. François Kleinberger (1862-1929), Hungarian art dealer

Option 4: purchase via a public auction

Research into the option of acquisition via a public auction has been part of extended additional research. This research included auction catalogues including (old master) paintings offered for sale in both France, Belgium, Holland, Germany, Austria and the UK in the period between 1850 and 1885.

Timeframe: 1850-1885

The indicated timeframe took the presumed start of the old master collection of Count Mniszech into consideration (roughly as of 1853 and coinciding with his arrival in France) and the transfer (via donation) of his then collection in 1885 to his son Léon at the occasion of the death of his first wife.

Auction catalogue research parameters

The technical parameters considered within the auction catalogue research were the dimensions of the panel (39 x 53 CM) with some dimensional margin, the shape of the painting (oval), the material (oil on wooden panel) and the description of (the main part of) the composition.

The art historical parameters to be considered within this particular research were attributions to both Salomon van Ruysdael, Frans de Hulst and Jan van Goyen (see also part II – Attribution) or the lack of these attributions, since the painting in question doesn't bear a signature and could therefore well have been put in an auction catalogue as 'anonymous' or 'Dutch school' or 'Flemish school' or even have been misattributed to another painter.

Additional provenance (part 1)

This research resulted in additional provenance or previous ownership of the painting and relates directly to a series of public auctions held in 1865 and 1866 in Paris. At the occasion of 4 auctions the Polish Prince Zygmunt Radziwill sold his art and painting collection which he had inherited from his father Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill and his grandfather Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and his grandmother Princess Helena Radziwillowa, both of which expanded the family painting collection.

overview additional provenance

previous owner	duration of ownership	acquisition
gap in provenance		
Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill & Princess Helena Radziwillowa	? until 1831	probably via art dealer or public auction
Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill	1831 until 1850	inheritance via his father Michal Hieronim Radziwill
Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa	1850 until 1864	inheritance via her husband Michal Gedeon Radziwill
Prince Zygmunt Radziwill	1864 until 1865	inheritance via his mother Aleksandra Radziwillowa



1



2

1. Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill (1744-1831)

Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill was a Polish-Lithuanian aristocrat and descendant of a long noble family line originating from Vilnius in Lithuania. Michal Hieronim was a very wealthy and versatile man. Besides being a major landowner he was active as both a diplomat and member of parliament. Together with his wife Helena he created a significant collection of old Dutch, German, Italian and Spanish master paintings and other works of art including a unique library, furniture and decorative art such as silver, porcelain, glass and fabrics.

In 1774 he acquired the Nieborów Palace as his main residence and in 1816 he added the Królikarnia mansion in Warsaw to his estate portfolio.

At this stage of my research it is not clear when and how Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and his wife Helena acquired the painting. The various potential options will be part of additional research (see also 'additional provenance research – part 2').

2. Princess Helena Radziwillowa (née Przezdziecka) (1753-1821)

Princess Helena Radziwillowa was a Polish aristocrat and wife of Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill whom she married in 1771. With Michal Hieronim she had 8 children, daughters Krystyna Magdalena, Aniela and Róża Katarzyna and sons Ludwik Mikołaj, Antoni Henryk, Michal Gedeon, Karol Lukasz and Andrzej Walentyn.

Besides being appointed as lady-in-waiting to Empress Catherine the Great she was widely known for her beauty and love affairs. Among these liaisons was her affair with the last king of Poland, Stanislaus August II Poniatowski.

With the help of architects Princess Helena designed a park in English style close to the Nieborów estate and named it Arkadia. Besides collecting paintings with her husband she would dedicate some 40 years of her life to the Arkadia park.



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3. Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill (1778-1850)

Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill was the son of Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and Princess Helena Radziwillowa. Michal Gedeon entered the army and was appointed to the rank of colonel and legion commander.

He participated in the Kosciuszko Uprising of 1794, a Polish national uprising against Russia and Prussia. In 1812 he participated in the Napoleonic campaign against Russia and served under the French marshal Etienne Macdonald.

After his retirement from the army he was appointed senator before being appointed commander-in-chief of the November Uprising against Russia (1830-1831). After the Polish defeat Michal Gedeon was imprisoned and exiled to Yaroslavl in Russia. In 1836 he was released and returned to Poland and lived in Warsaw until his death in 1850.

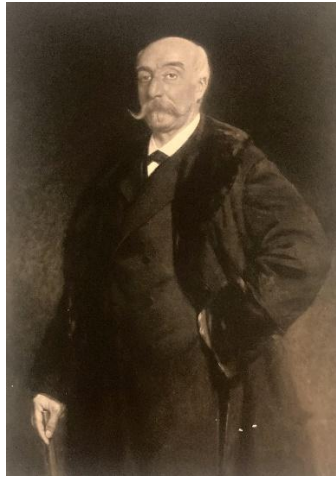
Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill acquired the painting as part of his inheritance after the death of his father in 1831.

4. Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa (née Steck) (1796-1864)

Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa was the wife of Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill and married him in 1815. With Michal Gedeon she had 3 children, daughter Michalina and sons Karol Andrzej and Zygmunt.

Together with her children she followed her husband into exile in Russia and returned with them to Poland in 1836. Besides looking after the health of her husband and managing the family estate Aleksandra was also active as an amateur painter. In 1863 she moved to France and lived in Paris until her death in 1864.

Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa acquired the painting as part of her inheritance after the death of her husband in 1850.



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5. Prince Zygmunt (Sigismund) Radziwill (1822-1892)

Prince Zygmunt (Sigismund) Radziwill was the son of Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill and Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa. After the death of his mother in 1864 he inherited the Nieborów Palace and the Królikarnia mansion which were acquired by his grandfather Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill. He also inherited the Radziwill family art and painting collection and thus came into possession of my painting.

Due to his excessive lifestyle and frequent travels he was much in need of money and therefore he sold both estates as well as the Arkadia park besides most of the painting and art collection established by his grandparents. In 1865 and 1866 a substantial part of the art and painting collection was put up for sale at a series of 4 auctions in Paris.

In 1879 Zygmunt Radziwill decided to settle permanently in Paris where he lived until his death in 1892.



Nieborów Palace



Villa Królikarnia, Warsaw

Based on currently available information the actual (temporary) location of the painting within the Radziwill collection could be established.

Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill bought the Królikarnia Palace in 1816 and moved part of his art and painting collection to this residence. In 1831 the painting was part of the inventory of the Królikarnia Palace located in Warsaw which was one of many residences owned by the Radziwill family.

revised provisional provenance overview

	previous owner	duration of ownership	Acquisition
	gap in provenance	prior to probably 1780-1830	
1	Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill & Princess Helena Radziwillowa	probably between 1780-1830 until 1831	probably via art dealer or public auction (1)
2	Prince Michal Gedeon Radziwill	1831 until 1850	inheritance via his father Michal Hieronim Radziwill
3	Princess Aleksandra Radziwillowa	1850 until 1864	inheritance via her husband Michal Gedeon Radziwill
4	Prince Zygmunt Radziwill	1864 until 1865	inheritance via his mother Aleksandra Radziwillowa
5	Count André Mniszech	probably 1865 until 1885	possible acquisition via auction in Paris in 1865 (2)
6	Count Léon Mniszech	1885 until 1901	donation by his father Count André Mniszech
7	François Kleinberger	1902 until ?	acquisition via auction in Paris in 1902
8	Gustav von Gerhardt	? until 1910	acquisition via art dealer François Kleinberger
9	Otto Kuhn	1911 until 1927	acquisition via auction in Berlin in 1911
10	Olga 'Olly' Kuhn	1927 until 1929	inheritance via her husband Otto Kuhn
11	Paul Brandt	1929 until ?	acquisition via auction in Amsterdam in 1929
	gap in provenance		
12	Benjamin & Nathan Katz	probably about 1935 until 1938	probably acquisition via private collector
13	Frank Mignot	probably about 1938 until 2003	acquisition via art dealers Benjamin & Nathan Katz
14	Marilies Mignot-Biermann	2003 until 2016	inheritance via her husband Frank Mignot
15	Marianne Mignot	2016 until 2019	inheritance via her mother Marilies Mignot-Biermann
16	Erik van der Graaf	2019 – present	acquisition via auction in The Hague in 2019

(1) acquisition by Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and Princess Helena Radziwillowa currently under investigation

(2) acquisition by Count Andrzej Mniszech currently under investigation

Additional provenance (part 2)

My painting was included in one of the Radziwill auctions held in 1865 in Paris. Current research puts a focus on the question whether Count Andrzej Mnischech acquired the painting at the 1865 auction or whether he acquired it later. It may be possible that Count Mnischech did not attend the 1865 auction in person and that he acquired the painting via his friend and painter-tutor Jean François Gigoux, a collector of old master paintings in his own right, who did attend the auction during which my painting was sold (see also option 2 – purchase via an art collector).

The next phase of provenance research will be focused on the sources of the Radziwill painting collection and the way in which the founders of this collection – Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and his wife Princess Helena Radziwillowa – acquired the painting in question.

Based on currently available information they slowly built this collection primarily between the late 18th century (starting in the 1780's) and the first decades of the 19th century until her death in 1821 and his death in 1831. Most likely they acquired my painting within this timeframe.

Possible previous provenance

There are various options to consider in view of the sources of the Radziwill painting collection and my painting. Previous research by Polish art historians has produced evidence indicating that Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and his wife acquired their paintings via inheritance, via gifts from friends and relatives and via acquisition during his travels to England and France in 1788-1789.

Other sources of this collection are purchases from French art dealer Jean-Baptiste Pierre Lebrun and English art dealer Edward Solly besides the auctions of the painting collections of Count Aleksander Chodkiewicz and Count Józef Sierakow among others.

Jean-Baptiste Pierre Lebrun

In view of currently available information the potential sources from which Prince Michal Hieronim Radziwill and his wife may have acquired the painting includes the French painter, art collector and art dealer Jean-Baptiste Pierre Lebrun (1748-1813) (husband of the French portrait painter Elisabeth Vigée-LeBrun).

Lebrun specialized in Dutch, French and Italian old master paintings and held a considerable number of auctions dedicated to old master paintings, art and antiques in Paris between 1771 and 1802.

Edward Solly

Another potential source for the painting is the English art collector and art dealer Edward Solly (1776-1844). Solly acquired a large collection of old master paintings of various schools which he sold to the King of Prussia in 1821.

In later life he continued to collect old master paintings – including Dutch 17th paintings – which were subsequently sold at auction in London between 1825 and 1837.

Count Aleksander Chodkiewicz

The old master painting collection of Polish Count Aleksander Chodkiewicz (1776-1838), a writer, politician and art collector, may be another potential source of the painting. He sold his collection via auction in 1824 and 1825.

Count Józef Sierakowski

The old master painting collection of Polish Count Józef Sierakowski (1765-1831), a historian, diplomat and art collector, may be another potential source of the painting. His collection of paintings was sold via auction in 1831.

II - Attribution

Based on my research I have been able to map an extensive series of previous attributions of the painting. This series starts with the generic attribution 'Flemish school' by Polish art historian Antoni Blank. In 1831 and in 1835 he was assigned to make an inventory of the Radziwill painting collection located in the Nieborów palace and the Królikarnia Palace.

At the occasion of one of the auctions of the Radziwill painting collection (which was held in May 1865 in Paris and included my painting) the French art expert Ferdinand Laneuville also provided a generic attribution 'Dutch-Flemish school' which derived from the previous attribution by Antoni Blank.

This series also includes attributions to Salomon van Ruysdael by French art expert Léon Roger Milès (in 1902), by Dutch art historian Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (both in 1902, 1911 and in 1929), by Hungarian art historian Gabriel von Térey (in 1911), by American-German art historian Wolfgang Stechow (both in 1938 and in 1975) and by Dutch art dealer Dirk Albert Hoogendijk (in 1963).

In 1929 the Dutch auctioneer, art dealer and art collector Anton Mensing attributed the painting to the anonymous painter referred to as 'monogrammist W.R.', a contemporary 17th century painter apparently influenced by Salomon van Ruysdael.

In 1963 Stechow expressed doubts as to his previous attribution made in 1938 towards Salomon van Ruysdael, yet he included the painting again in the second version of his catalogue raisonné on the oeuvre of Van Ruysdael which was subsequently published in 1975.

In 1991 the painting was attributed to Frans de Hulst by German art historian Hans-Ulrich Beck, an attribution which has later been endorsed and confirmed by the RKD in 2016.

provisional overview previous attributions

year	Attribution	attributor
1831	Flemish school	Antoni Blank (1)
1835	Flemish school	Antoni Blank (1)
1865	Dutch or Flemish school	Ferdinand Laneuville
1902	Salomon van Ruysdael	Léon Roger Milès
1902	Salomon van Ruysdael	Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (2)
1911	Salomon van Ruysdael	Gabriel von Térey
1911	Salomon van Ruysdael	Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (3)
1929	monogrammist W.R. anonymous follower Salomon van Ruysdael	Anton Mensing
1929	Salomon van Ruysdael	Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (4)
1938	Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow (5)
1963	anonymous follower Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow
1963	Salomon van Ruysdael	Dirk Albert Hoogendijk
1975	Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow (6)
1991	Frans de Hulst	Hans-Ulrich Beck (7)
2016	Frans de Hulst	RKD Netherlands Institute for Art History

(1) Polish art historian Antoni Blank was assigned by the Radziwill family to make an inventory of the painting collection and subsequent catalogue both in 1831 and in 1835

(2-4) Dutch art historian Cornelis Hofstede de Groot attended both the auctions in Paris (1902), in Berlin (1911) and in Amsterdam (1929) during which the painting was put up for sale in person and attributed the painting to Salomon van Ruysdael at each occasion

- (5) inclusion in first edition catalogue raisonné of Salomon van Ruysdael (1938)
- (6) inclusion in second edition catalogue raisonné of Salomon van Ruysdael (1975)
- (7) inclusion in catalogue raisonné of followers of Jan van Goyen (as Frans de Hulst) (1991)

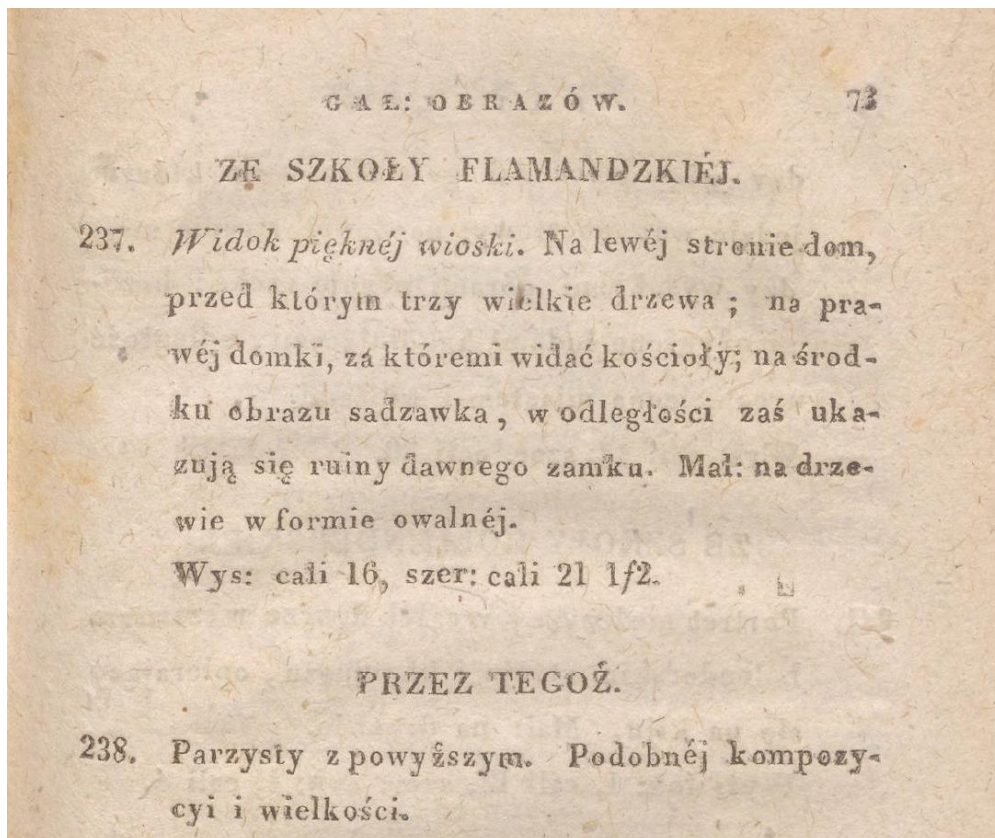
Scoping of attribution

Throughout my research I have kept an open mind as to potential candidates for attribution, yet based on various angles of investigation and types of evidence (including previous attributions, technical analysis, style analysis and provenance research) I have been focusing on Dutch landscapists active between 1630 and 1650.

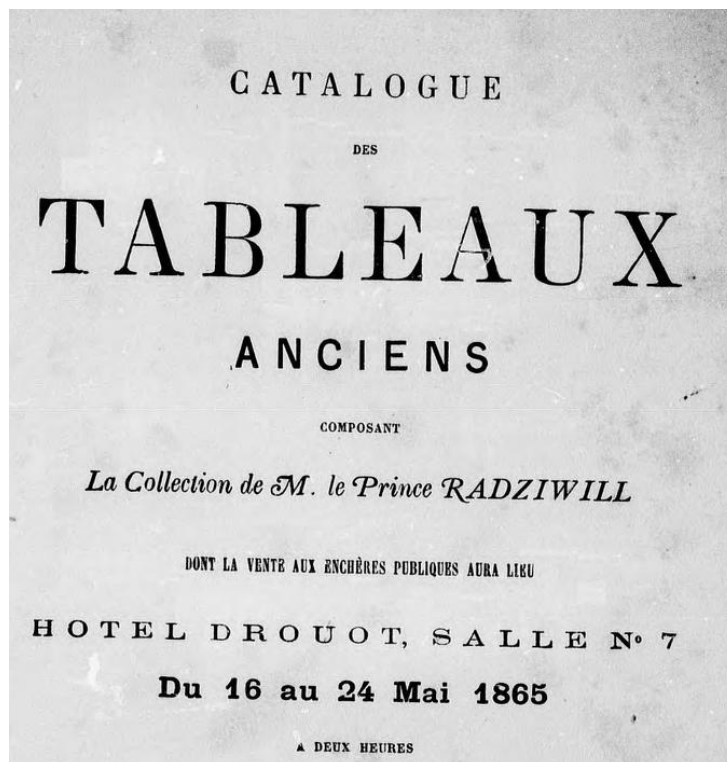
Within this particular scope I have put a special focus on both Salomon van Ruysdael and Frans de Hulst (in view of previous attributions). Next to them I have included Jan van Goyen as a potential other contender since his riverscapes made between 1630 and 1640 have proven to be very similar to those of Van Ruysdael dating from the same period in many cases.

De Hulst is considered to be a follower of both Salomon van Ruysdael and Jan van Goyen.

Photo gallery historical documentation and images related to the painting



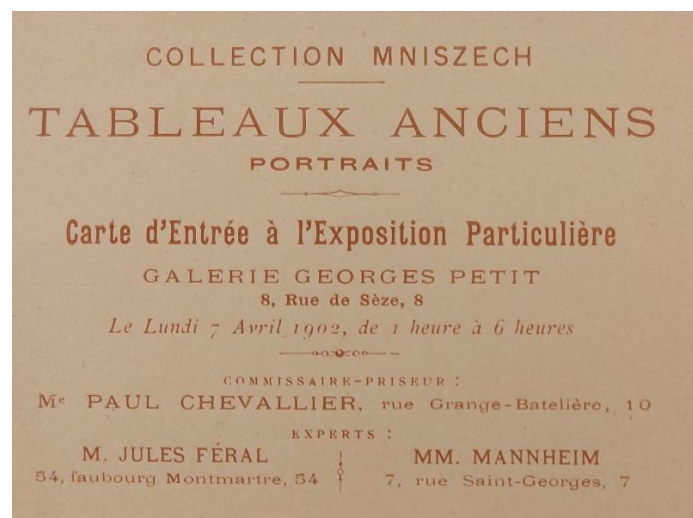
catalogue entry number 238, Radziwill painting collection, 1835



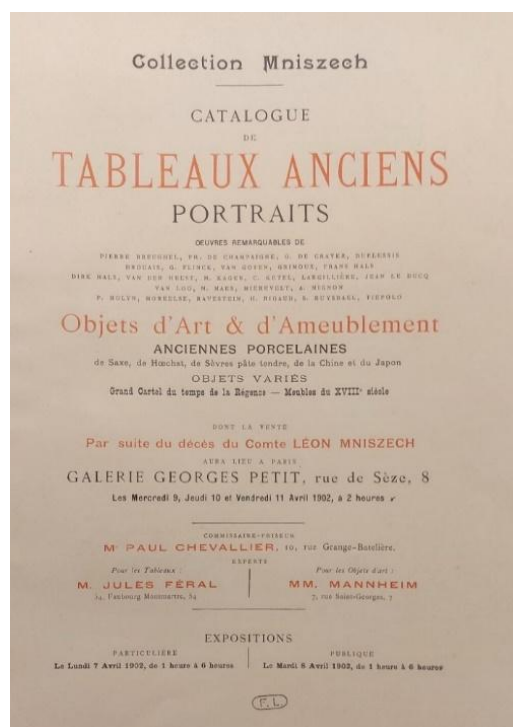
title page, auction catalogue Radziwill collection, Paris, May 16-24, 1865

ÉCOLES FLAMANDE ET HOLLANDAISE	
282 — Un Commandant d'armée et sa suite.	Cuivre. Haut. 17 cent.; larg. 25 cent.
283 — Bataille.	Cuivre. Haut. 17 cent.; larg. 25 cent.
284 — Paysage.	Ovale. Bois. Haut. 40 cent.; larg. 53 cent.
285 — Pendant du précédent.	Même mesure.

description lot numbers 284 and 285, auction catalogue, Paris, May 16-24, 1865



admission ticket viewing day auction Mniszech collection, Paris, April 7, 1902



title page, auction catalogue Mniszech collection, Paris, April 9, 1902

RUYSDAEL

(SALOMON)

172 — *Bords de rivière.*

Le clocher d'une église s'élève au milieu de chaumières entourées d'arbres. Quelques paysans se reposent assis sur une rive. Le canal s'étend sur la droite, animé de bateaux à voiles près d'un moulin à vent.

Bois de forme ovale. Haut., 40 cent., larg., 52 cent.

description lot number 172, auction catalogue, Paris, April 9, 1902



part of the Von Gerhardt art collection, Budapest, circa 1909

(*) notice the oval painting at the right low end of the corner of the room

SALOMON van RUIJSDAEL.

1623—1670.

Nr. 90.

Landschaft.

Dorf, von Bäumen umgeben, an einem breiten Gewässer. Land-
leute als Staffage. Trübes Wetter.

Auf eine ovale Holzplatte gemalt. H. 39,5 cm, B. 53 cm. S. R.

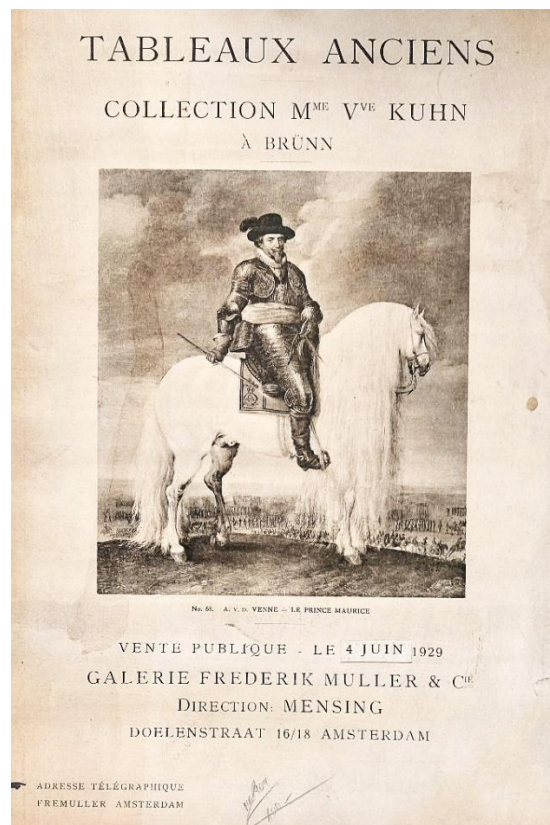
Abbildung auf Tafel 36.

description lot number 90, auction catalogue, Berlin, November 10, 1911



No. 90. SALOMON van RUIJSDAEL.

image lot number 90, auction catalogue, Berlin, November 10, 1911



title page, auction catalogue Kuhn collection, Amsterdam, June 4, 1929

46 Le village au bord de l'eau.

Sous un ciel bleu voilé de nuages gris, la tour carrée de l'église protège un amas de chaumières vétustes et branlantes. Des campagnards se reposent au bord de la rivière qui se prolonge à droite jusqu'à l'horizon où l'on aperçoit quelques petites voiles et un moulin à vent.

Bois ovale. — Hauteur 40, largeur 58 centimètres.

Tableau d'un maître semblable au précédent.

Voir la reproduction.

description lot number 46, auction catalogue, Amsterdam, June 4, 1929



photo of lot number 46, taken prior to the 1929 auction in Amsterdam

III - Technical research

Painting support

The use of oval shaped panels (or panels consisting of 2 individual planks joint together) as a support for (primarily) landscape paintings was a common practice among Dutch landscapists in the period between roughly 1630 and 1650.

Whilst the size of these oval panel paintings roughly ranges between 10 x 14 CM and 78 x 92 CM (height versus width), the dimensions of the bulk of these panels seem to have varied between 37 x 53 CM. Therefore the dimensions of this panel painting – 39 x 53 CM – can be considered as a fairly common size. Apart from numerous other landscape painters, both Salomon van Ruysdael, Jan van Goyen and Frans de Hulst made frequent use of the oval shaped format.

Dendrochronology

The painting has been submitted to a dendrochronological survey in 2020 by Marta Dominguez Delmás (DendroResearch, Wageningen, The Netherlands). This survey has resulted in a *post quem* dating of the panel of 1634 and revealed that the panel consists of 2 horizontal planks.

The type of wood applied for the panel is oak originating from the southern part of Lithuania. Taking an average of approximately 3-5 years into consideration to allow the felled wood to be dried and to be worked into a painting support (apart from transportation from the Baltic region to The Netherlands), the panel (or planks) in question could well have been readily available for painting by as early as 1637.

Infrared Reflectography

The painting has equally been submitted to an infrared reflectography survey in 2023 by René Gerritsen (René Gerritsen Art & Research Photography, Amsterdam, The Netherlands).

This survey revealed a clear (carbon based) underdrawing as a basis for the composition of the painting. Neither a signature (or monogram) nor a date has been identified as a result of the survey.



IRR image underdrawing of painting

Comparison of underdrawings

Currently I am investigating the use of underdrawings applied by both Salomon van Ruysdael, Jan van Goyen and Frans de Hulst in order to compare these types of underdrawings with the one detected under the surface of my painting.

Whilst it seems obvious that Van Goyen frequently made use of underdrawings in the preparation of his paintings throughout his active career, Van Ruysdael seems to have done so only during the early phase of his active career and up to 1640-1645. At this – preliminary – stage of this part of my investigation an undrawing by Frans de Hulst has surfaced in only one case so far.

The images included below were made available by the Nationalmuseum in Stockholm, Sweden and allow for a comparison of an underdrawing by Salomon van Ruysdael which he made in preparation of an oval oil painting depicting a rural landscape.



Salomon van Ruysdael, oil on oval panel, dimensions 36 ½ x 48 ½ cm
collection Nationalmuseum Stockholm



IRR image underdrawing of painting
collection Nationalmuseum Stockholm

IV - Comparative Composition & Style Analysis

Currently I am also in the process of conducting an extensive comparative analysis of both the composition and various stylistic aspects of the painting. This analysis includes comparisons with other contemporary (oval) paintings previously attributed to both Frans de Hulst, Salomon van Ruysdael, Jan van Goyen and to other contemporary landscape painters.

Stylistic comparison: 1st case

During my research related to similar riverscape compositions in the spring of 2022 I detected a painting in a private Dutch collection which is very close to my painting in terms of subject matter and execution besides shape and dimensions.



oil on oval panel, dimensions 39 ½ x 53 cm

Provenance

So far I have been able to establish some parts of the provenance of this painting as a result of research of sources in various countries.

The established sequence of provenance so far covers the period from circa 1870 until the present day and includes Austrian-French art dealer Charles Sedelmeyer, Austrian banker and art collector Baron 'Freiherr' Moritz von Königswarter, Dutch auctioneer, art dealer and art collector Anton Mensing, Dutch entrepreneur and art collector August Janssen and Dutch art dealer Jacques Goudstikker. Eventually – presumably in the 1920-1930 period – the painting ended up in the Dutch private collection where it is today.

Attribution

Based on my research I have been able to map a shortlist of previous attributions of this painting. This overview includes attributions to Salomon van Ruysdael by German-Dutch art expert Max J. Friedländer (in 1906), by Dutch art historian Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (in 1906), by Dutch art dealer Jacques Goudstikker (in 1936) and by American-German art historian Wolfgang Stechow (both in 1938 and in 1975).

In 1963 Stechow expressed doubts as to his previous attribution made in 1938 towards Salomon van Ruysdael, yet he included the painting again in the second version of his catalogue raisonné on the oeuvre of Van Ruysdael which was subsequently published in 1975.

In 1991 the painting was attributed to Frans de Hulst by German art historian Hans-Ulrich Beck, an attribution which has later been endorsed by the RKD in 2023.

provisional overview previous attributions

year	Attribution	Attributor
1906	Salomon van Ruysdael	Max J. Friedländer
1906	Salomon van Ruysdael	Cornelis Hofstede de Groot (*)
1936	Salomon van Ruysdael	Jacques Goudstikker (1)
1938	Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow (2)
1963	anonymous follower Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow
1975	Salomon van Ruysdael	Wolfgang Stechow (3)
1991	Frans de Hulst	Hans-Ulrich Beck (4)
2023	Frans de Hulst	RKD Netherlands Institute for Art History

- (*) Dutch art historian Cornelis Hofstede de Groot attended the auction in Berlin (1906) during which the painting was put up for sale in person and attributed the painting to Salomon van Ruysdael
- (1) inclusion in the catalogue of the 1st exhibition dedicated to the oeuvre of Salomon van Ruysdael by art dealer Jacques Goudstikker in Amsterdam (1936)
- (2) inclusion in first edition catalogue raisonné Salomon van Ruysdael (1938)
- (3) inclusion in second edition catalogue raisonné Salomon van Ruysdael (1975)
- (4) inclusion in catalogue raisonné followers Jan van Goyen (as Frans de Hulst) (1991)

Attribution analysis

My attribution research regarding my painting as well as those included in the comparative analysis of similar paintings also includes an analysis of the basis on which previous attributions have been founded and – if possible and available – the relevant argumentation leading toward any attribution.

This particular investigation puts a focus on available (either direct or circumstantial) evidence indicating if an attribution has been performed based on a physical analysis of the painting(s) in question and/or via other means such as photos (either in connection with previously recorded documentation related to attribution, provenance or other art historical sources).

Connaissanceurship

As such the complex notion of connoisseurship (attribution based on expert knowledge also referred to as ‘attribution by eye’) versus the combination of art historical and technical research is taken into consideration as well within the context of the study of previous attributions.

V - Comparison

The process of comparative analysis will include an additional number of Dutch 17th century oval riverscapes by or previously attributed to both Salomon van Ruysdael, Jan van Goyen, Frans de Hulst and Jan Coelenbier among others.



Painting 1
oil on oval panel, dimensions 39 x 53 cm
collection E.H. van der Graaf



Painting 2 (1st case stylistic comparison)
oil on oval panel dimensions 39 ½ x 53 cm
private collection, The Netherlands



Painting 3
oil on oval panel, dimensions 38 x 53 cm
private collection, location unknown



Painting 4
oil on oval panel dimensions 31 x 41 cm
private collection, The Netherlands



Painting 5
oil on oval panel, dimensions 39 x 52 cm
private collection, location unknown



Painting 6
oil on oval panel dimensions 39 x 52 cm
collection Musée des Beaux Arts Valenciennes